



- Cortés received twenty young indigenous women from vanquished natives, and he converted them all to Christianity
- Made alliances with enemies of the Aztecs as he marched to the capital city of Tenochtitlan
- When he arrived, the Aztec ruler Moctezuma gave lavish gifts of gold to the Spaniards which, rather than placating them, excited their ambitions for plunder



- Cortés learned that several Spaniards on the coast had been killed by Aztecs while supporting the Totonacs, and decided to take Moctezuma as a hostage in his own palace, indirectly ruling Tenochtitlán through him.



- 100,000 to 240,000 were killed in the campaign overall including warriors and civilians. As many as 40,000 Aztecs bodies were floating in the canals or awaiting burial after the siege of Tenochtitlán. Almost all of the Aztec nobility were dead, and the remaining survivors were mostly young women and very young children.

